

Launch — Step by Step (developer handoff)

GamerGain / PlayEarning Nexus · using the pre-built execution kit

How to read this: every step is tagged with who does it —

👤 **OWNER** (only you can; needs your identity/card) · ⚡ **DEVELOPER** (following the kit) ·

📄 **SCRIPT** ([launch.sh](#) does it) · ⏸ **WAIT** (external review/approval; nobody can rush it).

Cost of the developer's part: the ⚡ steps below total ~50-66 hours at \$75/hour =

~\$3,750-\$4,950 for the full PWA + Android + iOS launch. The 👤 owner steps and the fixed fees

(Apple \$99/yr, Google \$25, domain, hosting) are separate — see [GamerGain-Launch-Estimate.pdf](#).

PHASE 0 — Create the accounts (👤 OWNER) · ~a few hours of signups

You do these first; the developer can't (they need your identity, card, and legal agreement). Create an account and get the key for each, then write them into [API-KEYS-WORKSHEET.md](#):

- Hosting: **Railway** ([railway.app](#))
- Database: Railway Postgres (or Neon/Supabase)
- AI: **OpenAI** (or Anthropic)
- Email: **SendGrid** (or SES)
- File storage: **AWS S3**
- Payments: **Stripe** and **PayPal**
- Surveys: **BitLabs**
- SMS (optional): **Twilio**
- Google sign-in (optional): **Google Cloud OAuth**
- Mobile: **Apple Developer** (\$99/yr) and **Google Play Console** (\$25)
- A **domain** for your app

PHASE 1 — Fill in the keys (👤 OWNER) · ~30 min

- Open [API-KEYS-WORKSHEET.md](#) and paste in every value from Phase 0.
- Hand the developer: the repo, this file, and the filled-in worksheet. They now have everything.

PHASE 2 — Prep & validate (⚡ DEVELOPER + 📄 SCRIPT) · ~2-3 h

- Developer puts the keys into [backend/.env](#), then runs: `bash deploy-kit/launch.sh`.
- The script (📄) checks the keys, generates the secrets that can be auto-made, validates the build, loads the database schema (if `psql /DATABASE_URL` available), and smoke-tests the backend.

PHASE 3 — Deploy the backend, scheduler & frontend (⚡ DEVELOPER) · ~8-11 h

- Follow [railway/RAILWAY-DEPLOY.md](#) exactly: create the Railway project, add Postgres, deploy the backend + scheduler + frontend, set the env vars, generate the domains.
- Done when: [/health](#) is green, the scheduler logs show cron jobs, and the site loads and can sign up.

PHASE 4 — Test the money & earn loops (⚡ DEVELOPER) · ~12-16 h

- Run [PAYMENTS-TEST-CHECKLIST.md](#) (Stripe/PayPal sandbox → live, buy-credit, partner payout).
- Run [SURVEY-LOOP-TEST.md](#) (BitLabs → credit → oversight).
- Run [QA-CHECKLIST.md](#) on the live site.
- Run [LOAD-TEST-PLAN.md](#) — this is the **user-capacity test**: measure how many concurrent users the app handles, find where it bends first, and resize the servers from the real numbers. (+8-12 h; this is what turns "should handle 100k" into a measured figure you can trust.)

PHASE 5 — Build & submit the apps (🔧 DEVELOPER + ⌚ WAIT) · ~15-22 h + review wait

- Add the signing secrets (see [ANDROID-SUBMISSION-KIT.md](#) / [IOS-NO-MAC-KIT.md](#)), then in GitHub → **Actions** run **Android Build & Play** and **iOS Build & TestFlight** (builds in the cloud — no Mac).
- 🧑 OWNER + 🔧 DEVELOPER: fill the store listings (copy is provided), add the demo login, submit.
- ⌚ WAIT for Google and Apple review (days; iOS can need a resubmit — the kit's reviewer notes help).

PHASE 6 — Legal (🧑 OWNER, in parallel) · not developer time

- Get the provided Privacy Policy + Terms reviewed by a lawyer; publish them at public URLs.

PHASE 7 — Go live (🔧 DEVELOPER) · final checks

- Point your custom domain + HTTPS, flip payments to live, confirm the go-live checklist, turn the cron schedules on.

The hand-off checklist (give the developer all of this)

- [] The repo (already on GitHub) + this [LAUNCH-STEP-BY-STEP.md](#)
- [] The filled-in [API-KEYS-WORKSHEET.md](#)
- [] Access to the accounts they need to deploy (Railway, GitHub Actions secrets)
- [] The [deploy-kit/](#) folder (they'll follow its files phase by phase)

What only YOU (owner) must do — the short list

1. Create the accounts (Phase 0) and pay the fees (Apple \$99, Google \$25, domain, hosting).
2. Fill in the keys worksheet (Phase 1).
3. Get the legal pages lawyer-reviewed (Phase 6).
4. Approve going live.
Everything else is the developer following the kit — **~50-66 hours, ~\$3,750-\$4,950 at \$75/hr.**